

Queue-Ranking Worksheet (DP Section 4)

Day 4 · Activity 3 handout. Find where the time hides. List your top 3 queues, name the cause of each, name a candidate intervention — then rank by impact, effort, and risk.

If you're spending 6 weeks total and only 2–3 days of actual work, the other 5+ weeks are in the queues. This worksheet finds and ranks them.

Fill in your top 3 queues

For each queue, name the cause (capacity, policy, inertia, hidden dependency) and a candidate intervention (more capacity, different policy, parallel work, dependency removal). Then rank.

Queue	Time	Cause	Candidate intervention	Impact	Effort	Risk

- **Impact** — how much cycle time would shrink.
- **Effort** — how hard it is to fix (people-time, money, org change).
- **Risk** — what could go wrong.

Worked example — FieldPulse

Queue	Time	Cause	Candidate intervention
Spec → Estimate (1 week wait)	168 hrs	Sprint planning is bi-weekly	Mid-cycle sync to pre-load stories; OR mid-sprint pull
Build → Code review (1.5 days)	36 hrs	5 reviewers; PRs wait for them	Pair-review during dev; auto-assign reviewer
Discovery → Spec (varies; often weeks)	168+ hrs	Customer interview scheduling	Async interview cycles; lighter-weight discovery for known patterns

What "good" looks like

- Top 3 queues are **specific** — not "we're slow in code review," but "PRs wait 2 days for first review because we have 8 reviewers and 40 PRs/week."
- Each has a **named cause** — not just "we're slow."
- Each has a **candidate intervention** — not "be faster."